

Depulsor Desolatio

A Prolog text adventure

The Idea

A lone wanderer rides into **Dustfall**, a dying frontier town at the end of a forgotten trade road, ringed by endless dunes. For as long as anyone can remember, a gigantic camel-like monster, **The Depulsor**, has emerged from the desert each month to demand tribute: food, livestock, tools. Refuse, and it destroys. The town has paid for centuries.

Now the storehouses are nearly empty. Pay again and people starve; refuse and the monster comes. As the outsider, you must talk to the townsfolk, scavenge what the desert hides, and decide what to do before the next tribute falls due.

There is more than one way for your story to end. Choose carefully — courage alone may not be enough, time is running out, and the desert is not forgiving.

How To Play

Type commands in standard Prolog syntax, each ending with a full stop (`.`). Start with `start.` for the intro and the full command list.

Command	What it does
<code>n.</code> <code>s.</code> <code>e.</code> <code>w.</code>	Move in a direction
<code>in.</code> <code>out.</code>	Enter or leave a structure
<code>look.</code>	Look around again
<code>take(X).</code> <code>drop(X).</code>	Pick up / put down an object
<code>inventory.</code> (or <code>i.</code>)	List what you are carrying
<code>talk(Who).</code>	Talk to a townsperson
<code>buy(X).</code>	Buy something at the shop
<code>fill(lantern).</code> <code>light(lantern).</code>	Prepare your light source
<code>dig.</code>	Dig at your feet
<code>refill.</code>	Refill your canteen at the water tower
<code>deactivate.</code> / <code>fight.</code>	...when the moment comes
<code>instructions.</code>	Show the command list again
<code>halt.</code>	Quit

Mechanics & Puzzles

The game uses Prolog concepts such as recursion for lists and a dynamic knowledge base. It includes five core mechanics and adventure-puzzle types:

- **Limited resource** — water. Crossing the desert drains your canteen (tracked with arithmetic); run dry out there and you won't make it back. Refill in town.
- **Incomplete object** — a lantern is useless until you give it what it lacks and bring it to life. You'll want light before you go anywhere dark.
- **Hidden object** — the desert buries its secrets. Search the right spot and be persistent (you must dig once to hear a rattle, then dig again to find the component).
- **Locked door** — one way forward is sealed tight. Earn the means to open it by gaining the right person's trust.
- **Time limit** — every action takes time (steps). You must resolve the mystery before 50 steps, or Depulsor will arrive in town, forcing a hopeless final battle.

Talking to the townsfolk is how you learn what to do next — each has a hint, and one holds the key to everything.

Map of Dustfall

```

    Old Stable
      |
  Residential ----- Water Tower
                        |
  Magic Shop ----- Main Street ----- Sheriff's Office
                        |
                    Trade Road [ you start here ]
                        |
                    Deep Desert
                        |
                    ( the dunes... )
```

Make it across the dunes, and find out what The Depulsorr really is.